

LESSON NOTE

Selected Consonant Sounds /j/, /z/, /ʒ/

consonant sound is speech sound produced with an obstruction of the air stream. When a consonant sound is produced, the flow of air from the lungs is obstructed somewhere in the mouth by either the tongue, teeth or lips.

In the English language, there are twenty four (24) consonant sounds

Consonants are divided into two parts, namely;

- (a) Voiced Consonants
- (b) Voiceless Consonants

The voiced consonants are the consonants that the vocal cords vibrate when they are produced. There are fifteen voiced consonant sounds. Examples; /b/, /d/, /g/, /v/, /ð/, /z/, /ʒ/, /l/, /r/, /w/, /j/, /n/, /ŋ/, /m/, /dʒ/ In the production of voiceless consonants, the vocal cords do not vibrate. There are nine (9) voiceless consonant sounds. Examples; /p/, /t/, /k/, /f/, /s/, /θ/, /ʃ/, /tʃ/, /h/.

the selected consonant sounds /j/, /z/, /ʒ/

- /j/ is a palatal sound. It is a voiced consonant sound. It does not occur at the middle or end of words. It is produced with the front of the tongue raised and the lips in spread position.
- /j/ = y, ew, u, ue, eu, ui, iu, or eau
Yes /jes/, Young /jʌŋ/ Youth /ju:θ/ Yam /jæm/ Yeast /ji:st/
- /z/ is a labio-dental fricative. It is a voiced consonant sound. There is a partial obstruction of air when produced and the sound is released with a hissing sound.
- /z/ = z, zz, s, ss, x
Zero /zbrou/, zoo /zu:/, zebra /zebrə/, zeal /zi:l/, raze /reiz/, crazy /kreizi/
- /ʒ/ is also a fricative. It is a voiced consonant sound. It is produced in the same way as the consonant /z/. The letter symbols for the sounds /j/, /z/, /ʒ/ are:-
- /ʒ/ = su, si, gi, ge
Usual /ju:ʒi/, leisure /leʒə/, visual /viʒuəl/, pleasure /pleʒə/, treasure /treʒə/

Assignment: from the students textbook. Page 3 New concept English book 1.





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